COOLO_
FREE RESOURCE

THE HARD QUESTIONS.

MT. MAUNGANUI NEW ZEALAND COOLO.CO.NZ

**THE WORLD AND THE INTERNET GOT LOUD.
AND IT'S MOSTLY EMPTY, OR FULL OF BS.**

If you are for real about this, print this file. We use it, we recommend it, and there is something about the weight of paper that makes it tangible.

But, we also give a damn about the trees. So if you're just playing around, keep it digital. You can fill it as a PDF.

**WE LIKE WORKING WITH REAL PEOPLE.
WE WANT THE TRUTH.**

That's the entire point. Most brand questionnaires are stuffed with corporate filler and cookie-cutter advice. We don't care about "synergy" or "cutting-edge solutions." that are nice to have but about impossible to execute all at once.

**SO, GRAB A COFFEE/TEA/BEER/WINE.
SIT DOWN. ANSWER HONESTLY.**

If it feels uncomfortable, you're doing it right. If it's comfortable, you're playing it safe. And safe is invisible.

CLARITY OVER CLEVERNESS. MEANING OVER METRICS. REAL TALK FOR REAL WORK.

THIS IS A TOOL TO HELP YOU VISUALIZE YOUR BRAND'S SOUL.

STOP HIDING BEHIND MARKETING SPEAK. ANSWER THE HARD QUESTIONS. FILL IN THE BLANKS. FIND YOUR ACTUAL EDGE.

CONSIDER THIS A THERAPY SESSION FOR YOUR BUSINESS. MOST FOUNDERS ARE TOO CLOSE TO THE WORK TO SEE IT CLEARLY. THIS DOCUMENT IS DESIGNED TO PULL YOU OUT OF THE DAY-TO-DAY AND FORCE YOU TO LOOK AT THE RAW REALITY OF WHAT YOU'VE BUILT. GRAB A COFFEE. BE BRUTAL. IF THESE QUESTIONS DON'T MAKE YOU SLIGHTLY UNCOMFORTABLE, YOU AREN'T DIGGING DEEP ENOUGH.

01 / THE FOUNDATION

WHY ARE YOU ACTUALLY HERE?

02 / THE REALITY

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY SELL, MINUS THE BS.

03 / THE PEOPLE

IF YOU ARE FOR EVERYONE, YOU ARE FOR NO ONE.

04 / THE FIGHT

WHAT ARE YOU UP AGAINST?

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HOW YOU ACT WHEN NOBODY IS WATCHING.

06 / THE HORIZON

WHERE THIS WHOLE THING IS GOING.

If you get stuck, let's talk. HEY@COOLO.CO.NZ

01 / THE FOUNDATION

WHY ARE YOU ACTUALLY HERE?

Most businesses start to make money, but the ones that last start because they had to fix a broken system. This section digs into your actual reason for existing. If you don't know why you started, your customers won't know why they should care.

YOUR SPARK

What pissed you off, frustrated you, or inspired you enough to actually start this business?

THE IRREPLACEABLE TEST

If your business permanently closed its doors tomorrow, who would actually care? Not just inconvenienced—genuinely gutted.
(If the answer is "nobody," we have a problem).

02 / THE REALITY

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY SELL, MINUS THE FLUFF.

Founders love to dress up their services in fancy words to sound important. Let's strip that away. This section forces you to look at the brutal mechanics of what you do, what you suck at, and what your actual superpower is.

THE PLAIN ENGLISH PITCH

Explain what you do to a smart 12-year-old. You cannot use a single piece of industry jargon or corporate speak.

SHARP EDGE

What is the one thing you do better than anyone else? What is your actual superpower?

SACRIFICE

You cannot be the cheapest, the fastest, and the highest quality. What are you proudly bad at, so you can be exceptional at your edge?

THE HARD TRUTH

What is the hardest part about being your customer? Is it expensive? Is there a steep learning curve? Don't hide the friction. Naming it filters out the wrong people and builds trust.

03 / THE PEOPLE

IF YOU ARE FOR EVERYONE, YOU ARE FOR NO ONE.

The fastest way to become invisible is trying to please the whole world, and the internet all at once all together, impossible, almost unhuman task. This section helps you define exactly who you are talking to, and more importantly, who you need to actively turn away.

THE CLONE

Describe your absolute best customer. The one who pays on time, gets what you do, and recommends you to everyone. Who are they?

THE ANTI-CUSTOMER

Who should absolutely not buy from you? Who do you actively want to turn away?

THE SELFISH MOTIVE

Strip away the noble marketing logic. What is the raw, selfish, ego-driven, or lazy reason people actually hand you their money?

04 / THE FIGHT

WHAT ARE YOU UP AGAINST?

Great brands don't just sell things; they push against things. Your real enemy is rarely the business across the street. It’s usually a bad habit, a frustration, or an industry lie. This section defines your battleground.

THE ENEMY

Every great brand is fighting something. It’s usually a habit, a frustration, an outdated mindset, or a lie your industry tells. What exactly are you going to war against?

THE TRUE COMPETITOR

If you didn't exist, what exactly would your customers do to solve their problem?
Hint: It's often "doing it themselves" or "ignoring it," not another brand.

THE GUN TO THE HEAD

If you were forced to double your prices tomorrow, what would you have to change about your offer to make people still pay it?

05 / THE VIBE

HOW YOU ACT WHEN NOBODY IS WATCHING.

Your brand isn't a logo. It's a gut feeling. It’s how you sound, how you look, and the aftertaste you leave behind. This section checks if your outside appearance actually matches the quality of the work you do inside.

THE PERSONA

If your brand was a person sitting across the table, what three words describe their personality?

THE AFTERTASTE

How do you want people to feel the exact moment they finish interacting with your brand? (e.g., Relieved, smarter, energized, calm).

THE VISUAL TRUTH

Look at your website right now. Does it actually match the quality of your work, or does it look cheaper and older than you really are?

06 / THE HORIZON

WHERE THIS WHOLE THING IS GOING.

If you don't know where you are steering, you are just drifting. It's easy to get buried in the day-to-day operations. This section pulls you up to look at the long game, the looming threats, and the legacy you are actually building.

THE ENDGAME

Fast forward three years. Forget revenue targets for a second. What does a successful Tuesday look like in your business?

THE THREAT

What is the one internal weakness or external shift that could kill this business if you don’t fix it?

THE LEGACY

In ten years, what do you want this brand to be remembered for?

THE NEXT STEP

READ YOUR ANSWERS BACK. IF IT FEELS MESSY, THAT'S NORMAL. NOW, THAT IS THE ESSENCE OF YOUR ACTUAL BRAND.

CLARITY TAKES WORK.

If you get stuck, let's talk. HEY@COOLO.CO.NZ

IF YOU GET STUCK, LET'S TALK. STOP GUESSING. START BUILDING.

HEY@COOLO.CO.NZ

OR VISIT OUR WEBSITE FOR MORE:

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